5. What is recursive problem solving?

6. Define factorial of a natural number recursively.

SECTION - C

Short Answers

1. There are 7 tumblers on a table, all standing upside down. You are allowed to turn any 2 tumblers simultaneously in one move. Is it possible to reach a situation when all the tumblers are right side up? (Hint: The parity of the number of upside down tumblers is invariant.)

2. A knockout tournament is a series of games. Two players compete in each game; the loser is knocked out (i.e. does not play any more), the winner carries on. The winner of the tournament is the player that is left after all other players have been knocked out. Suppose there are 1234 players in a tournament. How many games are played before the tournament winner is decided?

3. King Vikramaditya has two magic swords. With one, he can cut off 19 heads of a dragon, but after that the dragon grows 13 heads. With the other sword, he can cut off 7 heads, but 22 new heads grow. If all heads are cut off, the dragon dies. If the dragon has originally 1000 heads, can it ever die? (Hint:The number of heads mod 3 is invariant.)

SECTION - D

Explain in detail

1. Assume an 8 × 8 chessboard with the usual coloring. "Recoloring" operation changes the color of all squares of a row or a column. You can recolor re-peatedly. The goal is to attain just one black square. Show that you cannot achieve the goal. (Hint: If a row or column has b black squares, it changes by (|8 - b) - b|).

2. Power can also be defined recursively as

$$a^n = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } n = 0 \\ a \times a^{n-1} & \text{if } n \text{ is odd} \\ a^{n/2} \times a^{n/2} & \text{if } n \text{ is even} \end{cases}$$

   Construct a recursive algorithm using this definition. How many multiplications are needed to calculate a^{10}?

3. A single-square-covered board is a board of 2^n x 2^n squares in which one square is covered with a single square tile. Show that it is possible to cover the this board with triominoes without overlap.

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